

iNBIO WeFunder Fundraising Playbook

Structured to match WeFunder's 4-phase playbook at wefunder.com/playbook.

PHASE ZERO: Create Content (Start BEFORE Pre-Launch)

WeFunder positions content creation before everything else. Content lays the foundation — it warms up your audience, creates familiarity, and gives early supporters a reason to care. Start this NOW, weeks before the round goes live.

WeFunder's 4 Principles of Good Founder Content

1. Be human, not corporate

Investors want to hear from Raj, not a polished brand voice. Speak plainly. Share real experiences. Let people see your personality and process.

- **Do:** A genuine quote about why you started iNBIO — builds trust and emotional connection
- **Don't:** Generic slogans like "Changing the world, one step at a time" — vague platitudes tell investors nothing meaningful

2. Show your work every week

Momentum is more credible when it's visible. Your job isn't to deliver a massive update every time — it's to stay present.

- **Do:** A quick photo of equipment testing with one sentence of context — natural, authentic, tied to real work
- **Don't:** Stock photos unrelated to iNBIO — feels artificial and erodes credibility

3. Focus on one idea at a time

The best posts are simple. One story. One metric. One insight. When in doubt, shorten it.

- **Do:** "We reduced reactor heat-up time by 30% after redesigning the fluidization nozzles." — specific, actionable progress
- **Don't:** "Big things coming soon..." — teasers without context feel empty and don't demonstrate execution

4. Make it visual

Photos, screenshots, diagrams, and short videos outperform text alone. Phone is fine — just use natural light, steady framing, clean background.

- **Do:** A simple photo or short video showing what you're working on — biochar samples, reactor components, a customer visiting, behind-the-scenes at the facility
 - **Don't:** Overly polished graphics, stock images, AI-generated visuals, or busy visuals full of text — these feel artificial and won't get approved for Spotlights
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Updates: Your Core Visibility Tool on WeFunder

Updates are the single most important content feature on WeFunder. Every time you post an update, it automatically distributes across THREE channels:

1. **Following Feed** — followers and investors see your progress in real time
2. **Email to all followers and investors** — reaches people even if they're not browsing WeFunder
3. **Added to your campaign page** — creates a visible track record that compounds trust over time

Updates are the backbone of your WeFunder presence. They don't have to be long or formal — just **consistent and real**. Each one is a snapshot: what you shipped, what you learned, what changed, what's happening behind the scenes.

iNBIO Update Topics (post weekly once the page is live):

- "We ran our first batch of forestry residuals from a new supplier this week. Yield data looked like..." [photo]
 - "Spoke with a concrete batch plant about biochar specs. Here's what they need..."
 - "Carbon credit pricing update: Puro.earth CORCs just traded at \$X. What this means for producers..."
 - "Equipment fabrication update — reactor vessel is 60% complete. Photos from the shop floor..."
 - "A stormwater engineer asked us to spec biochar for a municipal filter project. Here's the conversation..."
 - Fundraise progress and milestones
 - Industry news (ICVCM approvals, USDA funding, Holcim concrete breakthrough)
 - Team additions, advisory board, or partnership news
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Spotlights: Your High-Visibility Moment on WeFunder

This is a major visibility tool we originally missed.

While Updates reach your existing followers, **Spotlights introduce you to thousands of potential investors across the entire WeFunder community.** They're featured on the WeFunder homepage carousel.

How Spotlights work:

- WeFunder posts a new prompt each week (a thought-provoking question)
- You write an honest, personal response connecting to the prompt
- Your answer gets featured across the platform, including the homepage
- **They go through manual approval** — follow the prompt closely

What makes a good Spotlight response:

- Why you're building iNBIO — the mission, the spark, the motivation
- Why it matters NOW — market timing, the supply constraint, ICVCM approvals
- Key decisions you've made — choosing modular over fixed, the 3-service-line model, which markets to target first
- Personal stories — the first feedstock test that worked, a customer call that changed your thinking, a hard lesson from scaling
- Lessons from failures or hard-won wins — honesty builds trust faster than polish

What will get REJECTED:

- Vague slogans or "we're changing the world" messages
- AI-generated or overly polished marketing graphics
- Generic corporate messaging that doesn't connect to the prompt
- These feel hollow and won't get approved

Video format Spotlights are the most engaging. Even a 30-second phone recording of Raj answering the weekly prompt authentically will outperform a written response.

iNBIO Spotlight Response Examples:

Prompt: "Why did you start your company?"

"I spent years watching sawmills pay to haul away wood waste that had more energy in it than the diesel they burned to move it. The economics were backwards. I started iNBIO because I knew there was a way to capture that energy — and biochar turned out to be even more valuable than the fuel."

Prompt: "What's the hardest decision you've made as a founder?"

"Choosing to go modular instead of building a single large plant. Everyone in this space builds big. We chose to build small, containerized systems that ship to the feedstock instead of trucking feedstock to the plant. It took longer to get right, but now we can deploy anywhere without a \$50M construction project."

Prompt: "What keeps you going?"

"The math. Every ton of biochar we produce locks away 700-800 kg of CO2 for centuries and generates \$100-250 in carbon credits. That's on top of the product revenue. When the economics and the climate impact point in the same direction, you don't need external motivation."

LinkedIn Content Strategy (Start NOW, in parallel with WeFunder)

Raj's personal account is where cleantech investors live. Post 2-3x per week. One idea per post. Always include a photo or visual.

Post types with iNBIO examples:

- **Process posts:** "We ran 12 tons of pine residuals through the reactor yesterday. Here's what the bio-oil yield looked like..." [photo of product]
 - **Market signal posts:** "ICVCM just approved three biochar credit methodologies. Here's why that matters for anyone producing biochar..." [link to news]
 - **Behind-the-scenes posts:** "Most people don't realize our entire 25 TPD system fits in 4 shipping containers. Here's what it looks like on the truck..." [photo]
 - **Opinion posts:** "Everyone's talking about SAF. Here's the honest truth about where bio-oil-to-jet-fuel actually stands in 2026..."
 - **Customer story posts:** "A stormwater engineer called us last week asking if our biochar could hit spec for a municipal filter installation. Short answer: yes. Longer answer..."
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Content Rules (across all channels)

- No buzzwords. No "revolutionary." No "disrupting." Just describe what's real.
 - Include numbers. "\$164/ton carbon credits" beats "growing carbon markets."
 - Show the product. Real photos of biochar, bio-oil, the reactor, the container modules. NO stock images.
 - Be honest about what's hard. Investors trust founders who acknowledge challenges.
 - No AI-generated graphics or polished marketing visuals — WeFunder will reject them from Spotlights and they hurt trust.
 - One idea per post. Don't try to cover everything at once.
 - Phone photos with natural light > professional shoots that feel corporate.
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PHASE ONE: Pre-Launch

Create your pitch, secure your lead investor, and decide your terms to set your launch up for success.

2. Write Your Elevator Pitch

WeFunder requirements:

- **3-7 words, maximum 80 characters**
- A very smart ten-year-old should understand it immediately
- Simplest language possible — "your elevator pitch should be like baby food" (Michael Seibel)
- Don't include your company name (it already shows on your card)
- No jargon: avoid words like "pyrolysis," "biomass," "thermochemical"
- Aim for 7th grade readability or below (test at readable.com)

WeFunder examples for reference:

- "Flying cars. Seriously." (TerraFugia)
- "Banking stack for startups" (Mercury)

- "Oakland's first cidery" (Crooked City Cider)
- "Book rooms with locals rather than hotels" (Airbnb)

iNBIO Elevator Pitch Options (pick one):

Option A (strongest — simple, specific):

Turning wood waste into fuel and charcoal

6 words, 42 chars. Everyone knows wood waste, fuel, and charcoal. No jargon. Says exactly what we do.

Option B (outcome-focused):

Making money from waste no one wants

7 words, 36 chars. Intriguing, business-oriented. Makes people want to learn more.

Option C (product-focused):

Clean fuel and carbon credits from wood waste

8 words, 46 chars. Slightly longer but captures both product and carbon credit revenue.

Option D (ultra-simple):

Wood waste to fuel and fertilizer

6 words, 33 chars. "Fertilizer" is simpler than "biochar" for a general audience.

Check for these 5 mistakes before finalizing:

1. **Could you simplify further?** Keep iterating until you can't replace a word with something clearer.
2. **Industry jargon?** "Biomass," "pyrolysis," "syngas" — none of these belong in the elevator pitch. If your mom can't repeat it, simplify.
3. **Say it out loud.** Would you say this to someone at a bar? Nix words like *disrupting*, *revolutionizing*, *groundbreaking*, *innovative*.
4. **Test readability.** Paste it into readable.com. Aim for 7th grade level or below.
5. **Remove your company name.** "iNBIO turns wood waste into fuel" wastes characters — the name shows automatically.

Test it with real people:

1. Say your pitch out loud to 5-10 people who don't work in cleantech
2. Ask them to repeat back what they think iNBIO does
3. If they can't explain it clearly, simplify further
4. Your pitch is ready when a stranger can hear it once and explain your company to someone else

3. Produce Your Video

WeFunder says: Your video builds trust and connection. Investors are signing up to be part of your journey — they want to know who they're partnering with. **The most important part of your video is you — the founder.** If it's just Raj pitching directly to camera, that's perfectly fine. Don't skip the fundamentals.

Specs:

- Length: **1-3 minutes**
- Aspect ratio: Landscape (16:9)
- Resolution: 1080p or higher
- **Must have captions** — 60-90% of people watch without sound. Use Descript, Veed, or Kapwing to auto-caption.

Start with these 4 questions (from YC):

Before writing your script, answer these — they'll structure the whole pitch:

1. **What are we building and for whom?** Modular systems that turn wood waste into fuel, charcoal, and gas — for sawmills, farms, and municipalities.
2. **Why hasn't this been done before?** People have tried big, custom plants. Nobody built small, containerized systems that ship to the feedstock.
3. **Why is it hard to do what we're doing?** Getting consistent yields from variable feedstocks in a modular format. That's reactor engineering, not theory.
4. **Why is this an opportunity not to be missed?** Biochar market is supply-constrained, carbon credits at \$164/ton, concrete going carbon-negative. The market is buying faster than producers can scale.

WeFunder Script Template (fill in the blanks):

Hi, I'm **Raj Kathuria** and I'm the founder of **iNBIO**. We **turn wood waste into clean fuel and carbon-storing charcoal**.

We're building **modular systems** for **sawmills, farms, and municipalities** to solve **the billion-ton waste problem — wood and crop residues that get burned, buried, or left to rot**.

Today, **these operations** need to **get rid of waste** by **paying to haul it to landfills or burning it in the open**.

With **our systems**, they will be able to **convert that waste on-site into three sellable products — bio-oil, biochar, and syngas**, achieving **new revenue streams plus carbon credits worth \$100-250 per ton**.

I've spent **decades in biotechnology and process engineering**, and I **designed this reactor from the ground up, tested it across dozens of feedstocks, and certified the products to international standards**.

We're raising money on WeFunder because **we need capital to build and deploy our next systems. The biochar market is growing 13% a year and 62% of supply is already spoken for — the window to scale is now**.

This round of funding will allow us to **fabricate our next production system, lock feedstock supply agreements, and begin generating recurring revenue from product sales and carbon credits**.

We hope you'll join us in our journey. Invest in iNBIO today.

iNBIO Custom Script (alternative — more natural, less template)

[Scene 1 — Raj standing next to wood chips or feedstock pile, 20 sec]

"A billion tons of wood waste, crop residues, and forestry byproducts pile up in the U.S. every year. Most of it gets burned, buried, or left to rot. That's a massive amount of energy — wasted."

[Scene 2 — Walking through facility or toward equipment, 25 sec]

"At iNBIO, we built a modular system that converts that waste into three products: bio-oil that replaces fossil heating fuel, biochar that sequesters carbon for centuries, and syngas that powers the process itself. The whole thing fits in shipping containers and ships to your site."

[Scene 3 — Holding biochar sample, showing bio-oil jar, 25 sec]

"This is our biochar. It goes into farms, stormwater filters, and even concrete. Every ton we produce generates carbon removal credits worth \$100 to \$250. Holcim just used biochar to pour net-zero concrete at Canary Wharf. The market is real and it's growing 13% a year."

[Scene 4 — Raj direct to camera, 25 sec]

"We're not a science project. We have equipment, certified products, and three ways to make money — selling products, building plants at client sites, and selling the equipment itself. What we need is capital to scale. 62% of biochar supply is already locked up by repeat buyers."

If you want to own a piece of what's next in clean energy — invest in iNBIO."

Shoot in an intentional location

Don't sit at a random desk. Film somewhere that tells the story:

- **Best:** Standing next to the reactor or container modules — shows it's real industrial equipment
- **Good:** In the facility with product samples visible — biochar, bio-oil jars on a table
- **Also good:** Walking through a feedstock yard or wood waste pile — shows the problem
- WeFunder example: Earth Rides founder stands in front of a Tesla. Unity Wellness founders walk their production facility perimeter.

Extra footage to splice in (if you have time):

Beyond the talking-head pitch, consider splicing in:

1. Footage of biochar being produced — product being made
2. Close-up of the three products side by side
3. The modular container system on a truck or being deployed
4. B-roll of the facility, warehouse, or reactor
5. Team members talking about the mission
6. A customer or engineer examining the biochar

Do NOT use: Stock videos, stock photos, cartoon animations, or overly polished corporate graphics. Unless a clip adds to investors' understanding of your actual company, don't include it.

Production checklist:

- ☐ Film in landscape (16:9), 1080p+
- ☐ Natural lighting — no studio needed, phone is fine
- ☐ 1-3 minutes total
- ☐ Caption with Descript, Veed, or Kapwing (~\$15 to export without watermark)
- ☐ Show confidence and passion — "if you seem bored or angry, your chance of winning them over is next to zero" (Geoff Ralston)

4. Curate Your Highlights

WeFunder says: Highlights are the **3-8 most investable facts about YOUR company** — displayed prominently on your campaign page. They make you stand out, cause investors to stop scrolling, and pique curiosity enough to click.

Think about what a sharp investor wants to know:

1. **Traction** → What have you accomplished with limited resources? What evidence shows your product is working?
2. **Team** → What are your team's unfair advantages?
3. **Why now?** → Best evidence that your vision's timing is right
4. **What makes your company special?** → Product differentiation, IP, partnerships, moonshot mission, founding story

Michael Seibel (YC): *"What is the ratio between what you've done and how long you've been working on it?"*

What to include (WeFunder's priority ranking):

1. **Growth** (most powerful) — especially organic
2. **Revenue**
3. **Retention**
4. **Customers**

5. **Social Proof** (least powerful but still valuable)

iNBIO Highlights — Choose 5-8 of these:

Traction highlights (use as many as apply):

- 3 revenue streams from a single integrated process (bio-oil, biochar, syngas)
- 3 service lines launched: product sales, Build + Operate (EPC), OEM equipment
- Biochar certified to IBI and EBC international standards
- Reactor tested across multiple feedstocks with target yields achieved
- [ADD if available: \$ revenue to date, # of customers, # of tons processed, LOIs signed]

Team highlights:

- Founder designed the reactor, characterized the feedstocks, and certified the products — engineer-turned-CEO, not the other way around
- Decades of experience in biotechnology, process engineering, and cleantech commercialization
- [ADD: any previous exits, notable employers, university affiliations, advisory board members]

Why now highlights:

- ICVCM approved 3 biochar credit methodologies in 2026 — institutional credibility unlocked
- Biochar carbon credits averaging \$164/ton, up 25% in 2 years
- 62% of high-quality biochar supply locked by repeat buyers — supply-constrained market
- EU Carbon Removal Certification Framework operational in 2026

What makes iNBIO special highlights:

- Modular systems factory-built in 40-ft shipping containers — deploy anywhere without a \$50M construction project
- Thermally self-sufficient: syngas recycles to heat the reactor, no external fuel needed
- Only company offering all three models: full-service, turnkey, and build-train-transfer

Market size highlight (use sparingly — WeFunder says traction > market stats):

- \$50B+ addressable market across biochar, SAF, carbon credits, and renewable fuels

What NOT to put in highlights:

- Generic market stats without tying them to your company
- Vague claims ("proven technology") — use specific numbers
- Anything an investor can't verify or that sounds like marketing copy
- Don't just list features — show accomplishments and evidence

Example formats that work well:

- "3 product streams, 3 service lines, 1 integrated process"
- "Biochar certified to IBI/EBC standards — ready for agriculture, stormwater, and construction"
- "Reactor designed, tested, and proven across forestry and agricultural feedstocks"
- "\$164/ton carbon credits — and ICVCM just approved 3 biochar methodologies"
- "[X] tons processed to date" ← *this is the most powerful if you have it*
- "[X] customers or LOIs signed" ← *second most powerful*

5. Create Your Pitch

WeFunder says: Your pitch is the full story of your company told through slides — a series of images and text that persuades investors to believe in your company and invest. Think of it like a pitch deck in a VC meeting, but on a web page for a broader audience.

Your pitch should:

- Tell a complete, easy-to-follow story
- Be visually compelling and scannable
- Use simple language anyone can understand
- Include data, evidence, and social proof wherever possible

How to create clear slides:

- **Use large text** — the most important thing on the slide should be the biggest
- **Include a visual** — charts, screenshots, photos, and icons help investors process information faster
- **Be direct** — if you can cut a word, cut it
- **Avoid walls of text** — if a slide has more than 5 lines of body text, break it up or move details to a separate slide

Narrative arc (follow this order):

The best pitches follow a story, not a list of facts:

1. **Hook** — Start with something that grabs attention
2. **Problem** — Show the pain point
3. **Solution** — Introduce your product
4. **Proof** — Show it's working (traction)
5. **Vision** — Paint the picture of the future
6. **Team** — Show you can execute
7. **The Ask** — What you're raising and why

iNBIO Pitch Slides:

SLIDE 1 — HOOK

Header (large text): 1 billion tons of wood waste. 3 products. Zero fossil fuel needed.

Visual: Split image — wood waste pile on left, three products (bio-oil jar, biochar granules, syngas flame) on right

Body (max 3 lines): Every year, a billion tons of U.S. farm and forestry waste gets burned or buried. We built machines that turn it into fuel, charcoal, and gas — in under 2 seconds.

SLIDE 2 — PROBLEM

Header (large text): A billion tons of waste. Burning it costs money and pollutes the air.

Visual: Photo of open burning or waste piles, or a simple chart showing waste volume vs. current disposal methods

Body (max 5 lines): Sawmills pay to haul waste. Farmers burn crop residues in the open. Municipalities landfill wood debris. All of it releases CO₂ and methane. Meanwhile, industries pay premium prices for heating oil, soil amendments, and carbon offsets that this waste could produce.

The technology to convert waste exists. What didn't exist was a modular, affordable system a sawmill or farm could actually deploy.

SLIDE 3 — SOLUTION

Header (large text): 3 products from 1 machine. Ships in containers.

Visual: Photo of modular container system + product samples side by side

Body (max 5 lines):

- **Bio-oil (40-70%)** — Replaces fossil heating oil. SAF feedstock.
- **Biochar (15-40%)** — Farms, stormwater filters, concrete. Carbon credits at \$100-250/ton.

- **Syngas (7-20%)** — Powers the reactor. No external fuel needed.

5 TPD fits in one container. 75 TPD uses eight. Ship to site. Interconnect. Run.

SLIDE 4 — PROOF (TRACTION)

Header (large text): Designed, built, tested, certified.

Visual: Timeline graphic or milestone chart. If available, a revenue/growth chart.

Body (max 5 lines):

1. Proprietary reactor — target yields achieved across forestry and ag feedstocks
 2. Modular architecture — 5 to 75 TPD, factory-built in shipping containers
 3. Biochar certified to IBI/EBC international standards
 4. 3 service lines live: product sales, Build + Operate, OEM equipment
 5. [ADD: revenue, tons processed, customers, LOIs — the more specific the better]
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SLIDE 5 — BUSINESS MODEL

Header (large text): 3 ways to make money. Plus carbon credits on top.

Visual: Simple diagram showing the 3 revenue lines, or a pie chart of revenue mix

Body (max 5 lines):

1. **Sell products** — biochar + bio-oil to farms, cities, and industry
 2. **Build + operate plants** — EPC at client sites (full-service, turnkey, or train-and-transfer)
 3. **Sell equipment** — modular systems (5-75 TPD) to operators
 4. **Carbon credits** — every ton of biochar = \$100-250 in credit revenue, stacked on top
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SLIDE 6 — OPPORTUNITY SIZE

Header (large text): \$50B+ market. Supply can't keep up with demand.

Visual: TAM/SAM/SOM breakdown or market size chart with growth arrows

Body (max 5 lines):

- Biochar: \$970M → \$3.1B by 2030 (13% CAGR). 62% of supply already locked.
 - Carbon credits: \$164/ton avg. Microsoft, JP Morgan buying. \$1.35B by 2030.
 - SAF: \$84B by 2035. Bio-oil is a feedstock.
 - Concrete: Holcim poured net-zero concrete with biochar at Canary Wharf.
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SLIDE 7 — TEAM

Header (large text): Built by the engineer who designed the reactor.

Visual: Raj's headshot + education/company logos. Add any advisors or team members.

Body (1-2 credentials per person, max 5 lines):

Raj Kathuria — Founder & CEO Decades in biotech and process engineering. Designed the reactor, characterized feedstocks, certified the products. Engineer-turned-CEO, not the other way around.

[Add: education, previous companies, advisory board, any notable logos]

SLIDE 8 — CUSTOMER TESTIMONIALS

Header (large text): What our customers say.

Visual: Customer photos with quote overlays. Real names and companies.

WeFunder says: Let your customers speak for you. Real quotes from real people are incredibly persuasive. Include name, photo, and a short quote.

[Raj needs to provide actual customer quotes. If not available yet, use these use-case scenarios as placeholders and replace with real testimonials ASAP:]

- **Sawmill operator:** "We were paying \$X/ton to haul waste. Now it's a revenue stream."
- **Stormwater engineer:** "The biochar hit spec on the first test. Removal rates exceeded what we modeled."
- **Farmer:** "Soil moisture improved in the first season. I'm ordering more."

SLIDE 9 — PRESS

Header (large text): In the news.

Visual: Press outlet logos + quote snippets

WeFunder says: If you've been featured in press, show it. Logos and quotes add credibility and social proof.

[Add any: press mentions, podcast appearances, conference presentations, US Biochar Initiative features, local media coverage. If none yet, skip this slide — don't fabricate.]

SLIDE 10 — USE OF FUNDS

Header (large text): Here's how we'll use your investment.

Visual: **Pie chart or bar chart** — WeFunder specifically says these work great here. Be specific about categories and percentages.

Category	%
Equipment & Manufacturing	40%
Facility & Site Development	20%
Feedstock Supply Chain	15%
Sales & Marketing	15%
Working Capital & Operations	10%

[Create a clean pie chart with these categories. Adjust percentages to match actual raise target.]

SLIDE 11 — GAME PLAN (VISION)

Header (large text): From this round to recurring revenue in 12 months.

Visual: Timeline graphic with milestone markers

1. **Q2 2026** — Close round. Equipment procurement.
2. **Q3 2026** — Fabrication. Lock feedstock agreements.
3. **Q4 2026** — Deploy and commission. First production.
4. **Q1 2027** — Steady-state. Product shipments. First carbon credits.
5. **Q2 2027** — First Build + Operate client signed.

SLIDE 12 — CTA (End on a sincere ask)

Header (large text): Waste is a resource. Help us prove it at scale.

WeFunder says: Your last slide should be a clear, compelling call to action. Tell investors exactly how to invest, and close with a **personal note about why this matters to you**.

Body (max 5 lines): 62% of biochar supply is locked up. Carbon credits are at \$164/ton. The market is buying faster than producers can build. We have the technology and the products. This round funds our next deployment.

If you believe waste shouldn't be wasted — invest in iNBIO.

[Include the "Invest" button link]

6. Choose Your Cover Image (Main Image)

WeFunder says: Your main image is the very first thing investors see — in the Discover feed, on your campaign page, in social media cards, and in newsletter features. It has to do the heavy lifting of a first impression. It needs to stop the scroll and make someone curious enough to click.

It appears at different sizes — from a small card in the browse feed to a full-width banner — so it needs to read well at both scales.

Choose an image that:

1. **Stops the scroll** — stands out visually
2. **Creates an emotional reaction** — not just informational
3. **Communicates what you do instantly** — one glance should tell the story
4. **Makes people want to click and learn more**

"The best images are authentic, high-quality, and tell a story about your company in a single frame."

WeFunder's 6 image categories (with iNBIO recommendations):

1. You and your product (BEST for iNBIO) Raj holding biochar, standing next to the reactor, or demonstrating the product. Combines the human element with what you're building. This is WeFunder's strongest category.

Example: Raj holding a handful of biochar with the modular container system behind him

2. A user with your product A customer or engineer using iNBIO biochar — applying it to soil, examining it in a lab, pouring it into a stormwater filter. Creates aspirational appeal.

3. Just your product A beautiful shot of the three products: bio-oil jar, biochar granules, syngas flame. Works well for physical products with strong visual appeal.

4. Just your team Group photo at the facility showing energy and chemistry. Works well if the team is the story.

5. A symbolic photo A powerful image representing the mission — wood waste being transformed, or a before/after of waste vs. products. Best for cause-driven framing.

6. A meaningful mockup or screenshot Not relevant for iNBIO (this is for software companies).

Restrictions — MUST follow:

- **No text overlays** — your company name and tagline already appear on the campaign card. Adding text creates visual clutter.
- **No logos** — same reason, your logo is already displayed.
- **High resolution** — blurry or pixelated images immediately reduce credibility.
- **Landscape orientation** — the campaign card is wider than tall, so landscape images work best.

iNBIO recommendation (updated priority):

1. **Best:** Raj holding biochar or standing with the reactor/container system — human + product in one frame
2. **Strong:** The three products arranged together (bio-oil jar, biochar, flame) — tells the whole story visually
3. **Good:** Modular container system being deployed — shows industrial scale
4. **Acceptable:** Team at the facility — shows it's real, not theoretical

Avoid: Stock images, abstract graphics, logo-only, PowerPoint-style slides, or any image with text burned into it.

7. Onboard Your Lead Investor

WeFunder says: Your lead investor is the first person to invest in your round. They set or validate the terms, and their investment is a **public-facing signal of confidence** to every investor who follows. On WeFunder, your lead is the public face backing your company from day one — not behind closed doors like a VC deal.

What the lead investor actually does:

- **Holds the sole voting right for the SPV** — votes on behalf of all WeFunder investors when the company needs shareholder approval (new financing, acquisition, dissolution)
- **Sets or validates the valuation and terms** — most of the work happens before launch
- **Invests first** — their check is the visible signal that someone credible has already committed
- **Day-to-day time commitment is minimal** — mostly pre-launch review and terms alignment

Requirements:

Minimum investment: At least **\$5,000**, but WeFunder strongly recommends **\$10,000 or 5-15% of your funding goal**. If investors see the lead didn't put in \$10K, they'll be unlikely to put in \$15K themselves.

Who CANNOT be your lead investor:

- A founder or officer of the company (Raj cannot be lead)
- A direct family member of a founder (spouse, parent, sibling, child)
- Anyone employed by or compensated by the company
- The lead must be an **independent voice** representing investor community interests

Risk mitigation: If you don't meet your minimum funding goal, the lead investor's money is returned along with everyone else's. No obligation to invest more or fund the gap.

How to choose the right lead:

First and foremost: make sure you trust them. They hold voting power for your Community Round and might be in your business for the next ten years.

Signal social proof with a trusted name. WeFunder says: "If that person is investing \$100K as a lead, then I'm a lot more confident investing my \$2,000." Biotechs have chosen doctors and research scientists. Tech companies have chosen VCs and angels. You don't need a celebrity — just someone whose name makes others feel confident following.

iNBIO lead investor candidates:

Ideal profile for iNBIO:

- Cleantech/climate-tech investor with a track record
- Someone in the biochar, biomass, or carbon credit space
- An operator who understands industrial equipment economics
- Ajay Tandon (T&C Capital) — already involved per email thread, could serve as lead

Action items:

- ☐ Confirm lead investor candidate (Ajay Tandon or other — must NOT be Raj, family, or employee)

- ☐ Align on valuation, terms, and their investment amount (minimum \$5K, ideally \$10K+)
 - ☐ Have the lead review the campaign page before launch
 - ☐ Get a 2-3 sentence "why I invested" quote for the page
 - ☐ Confirm they understand the SPV voting responsibility
-

PHASE TWO: Soft Launch

Start raising money from angel investors, friends and family, customers, and other supporters to build momentum.

1. How Soft Launch Works

When does it start? After you've set up your campaign, secured your Lead Investor, and you're ready to start raising. Soft Launch begins the moment you share your campaign link with your first potential investor.

Key distinction:

- **Soft Launch = Private.** Your campaign is NOT listed on WeFunder's public Explore page. Only people you share the direct link with can see it. This is your chance to build momentum with your inner circle.
- **Public Launch = Public.** Your campaign goes live on WeFunder's Explore page for anyone to discover.

Why 25%? The goal of Soft Launch is to reach at least **25% of your funding goal** before going public. This is the threshold where social proof kicks in — new investors see existing momentum and feel confident following. People invest where other people are already investing.

The 5 basics of Soft Launch:

1. **Start with your warmest contacts** — people who already know and support you
2. **Use personal 1:1 outreach** — not mass emails, not social posts. Soft launch is individual conversations only.
3. **Ask for specific amounts** — "Would you consider investing \$500?" is far more effective than "Please check out my campaign"
4. **Track everything** — use a CRM or spreadsheet to track who you've contacted, their response, and follow-ups
5. **Target 25% funded** — don't go public until you hit this. The social proof makes everything after easier.

iNBIO Soft Launch Target: Raise 25% of goal through personal 1:1 outreach before going public.

2. Craft Personal Outreach to Existing Angels

WeFunder says: Not a BCC, group chat, or social post. Take the time to send 1:1 outreach to existing angels and stack your first checks. This step takes the most time but compounds your momentum for everything that follows.

Step 1: Set a goal for your personal outreach

Answer these before you start:

- How many personal messages will you send? ____ (target 50+)
- How much investment volume are you targeting? \$____ (ideally at least 25% of funding goal)

Step 2: Prepare your calendar, pitch, and FAQs

- Set up a **Calendly or scheduling link** — angels you're asking will want to meet
- **Block time** in your days for investor meetings. Really try to **stack them** so you can get back to running the company
- Practice your pitch with total confidence and conviction
- Prepare follow-up materials: your deck, your WeFunder link, and answers to common questions

Step 3: Add 50+ people to a CRM

Brainstorm everyone: family, friends, community members, early supporters, angel investors. List the check size you're targeting from each.

iNBIO contact tiers:

Tier 1 — Inner circle (they know you and iNBIO well):

- Ajay Tandon / T&C Capital
- Existing iNBIO advisors or board members
- Friends and family who've expressed interest
- Previous business partners of Raj

Tier 2 — Warm (they know you, may need a milestone refresher):

- Cleantech and climate-tech angels (LinkedIn connections)
- US Biochar Initiative contacts
- Industry conference contacts (tcbiomass, etc.)
- Local Delmarva business community

Tier 3 — Warm-ish (they may need a full refresher on iNBIO):

- LinkedIn followers engaged with Raj's content
- People who signed up on /invest email list
- WeFunder's own angel network
- Industry newsletter subscribers

Step 4: Draft your personal outreach

Three templates based on how well they know you:

TEMPLATE A — Inner Circle (they know you, your company, and recent milestones)

Initial Outreach: SMS, DM, or Email

Hi [Name], [personal touch]. I'm opening a private investment round for iNBIO and would love to have you join as an early investor. We've soft launched here: [WeFunder link]. Would you be free to chat about it this week? Would you consider investing \$[amount]?

Follow-up (3-5 days later): SMS, DM, or Email

Hi [Name], wanted to follow up on this. Let me know if you'd be open to investing early in our round — you can do so here: [WeFunder link]. Happy to discuss more: [Calendly link]. Thanks!

TEMPLATE B — Needs Milestone Refresher (they know you but need an update on progress)

Initial Outreach: Email

Hi [Name],

[Personal touch]

As you may know, iNBIO recently achieved [milestone — e.g., IBI/EBC biochar certification / ICVCM credit methodology approval / new customer engagement]. We're opening a private investment round of \$[goal] to [deploy our next production system and begin generating recurring revenue].

Would you be interested in investing early? I'm also happy to share more on a 15-minute call: [Calendly link]

Thanks so much. Raj

Follow-up: Email

Hi [Name],

Following up on my last message. Would you be interested in joining our round as an early investor? We're currently at [X%] of our goal and growing fast. Invest here: [WeFunder link]

TEMPLATE C — Needs Full Refresher (they know you but not iNBIO specifically)

Initial Outreach: Email

Hi [Name],

[Personal touch]

I'm the founder of iNBIO. We turn wood waste into clean fuel and carbon-storing charcoal using modular systems that ship in containers.

I wanted to reach out because [relevant connection — e.g., we met at tcbiomass / you work in cleantech / we share an interest in carbon markets]. We're raising a private round on WeFunder to scale production — the biochar market is approaching \$1B and 62% of supply is already locked up.

Would love to have you as an investor. See the details: [WeFunder link]

Happy to chat more: [Calendly link]

Raj

Key tactic — ask for a specific amount. "Would you consider investing \$500?" is far more effective than "Please check out my campaign." Calibrate: \$500-\$1K for friends/family, \$5K-\$25K for angels, \$10K+ for industry contacts.

Step 5: Update your CRM and be persistent!

After sending your first batch, track responses in your CRM. Follow up with anyone who hasn't responded within **3-5 days**.

Persistence matters. Most investors won't invest on the first ask. Plan for **2-3 follow-ups** with each contact.

Key metrics to track:

- Messages sent
- Responses received
- Meetings booked
- Investments committed
- Follow-ups needed

3. Email Your Existing Mailing Lists

WeFunder says: This is different from personal outreach. Personal outreach is 1:1, intimate, and asks for a specific commitment. Your mailing list announcement is a **1-to-many invitation** — letting your community know about an exciting opportunity. The tone is more "exciting news" than "would you invest \$500?"

Step 1: Draft a 3-part email series

Rather than sending a single email, WeFunder recommends a **3-part series**:

Email 1: The Tease (sent 2-3 days before soft launch)

- Subject: "Something big is coming from iNBIO"
- Build anticipation without revealing everything

- Hint at the opportunity

Subject: Something big is coming

Hi [Name],

We've been building something at iNBIO for a long time, and we're about to take a major step forward. In the next few days, I'll be sharing an opportunity for you to be part of it.

Stay tuned — more details coming soon.

— Raj

Email 2: The Announcement (soft launch day)

- Subject: "You can now invest in iNBIO"
- Explain what the round is
- Share your why
- Clear CTA to invest
- **Keep it under 300 words**

Subject: You can now invest in iNBIO

Hi [Name],

I'm opening iNBIO's private investment round — and I wanted you to be among the first to know.

We turn wood waste into three products: bio-oil (replaces fossil fuel), biochar (sequesters carbon for centuries), and syngas (powers the process itself). Our systems are modular, ship in containers, and deploy at the customer's site.

Why now? The biochar market is approaching \$1B and 62% of supply is already locked up. Carbon credits average \$164/ton. ICVCM just approved three biochar credit methodologies. The market is ready — we need capital to scale production.

You can review the details and invest here: [WeFunder link]

This round is open to accredited investors. If you have questions, reply to this email or book a call: [Calendly link]

— Raj Kathuria, Founder & CEO

Email 3: The Follow-Up (3-5 days after launch)

- Subject: "We've already raised \$X from Y investors"
- Share early momentum
- Social proof from early investors
- Reminder to invest

Subject: iNBIO has raised \$[X] from [Y] investors — and we're just getting started

Hi [Name],

A quick update: since opening our round [X] days ago, [Y] investors have committed \$[X]. The momentum has been incredible.

If you've been considering getting involved, now is the time — early investors are already in, and the round won't stay open forever.

Invest here: [WeFunder link]

— Raj

[Use your Resend infrastructure — you already have the API and subscriber list built]

Step 2: Take note of feedback and adjust

Pay attention to:

- **Open rates and click rates** — are people engaging?
- **Questions people reply with** — what's confusing?
- **Common objections or confusion** — what's holding people back?

Use this feedback to **refine your campaign before going public**. If people are confused about something, add clarity to your pitch slides.

4. Track Your Outreach

WeFunder says: Track everything. Use a CRM or spreadsheet with these columns:

Name	Contact	Tier	Date Contacted	Asked Amount	Response	Follow-up Date	Invested?
		1/2/3		\$X	Yes/No/Maybe		Y/N

- Follow up once after 3-5 days if no response
 - Don't follow up more than twice — respect the relationship
 - Update the tracker daily during soft launch
 - When you hit 25% funded, you're ready for Public Launch
-

PHASE THREE: Public Launch

Reach beyond your personal network using social media, ads, WeFunder's marketing perks, and other promotions. Aim to reach 65%+ of your funding goal before moving into Closing.

Note: For a Reg D 506(c), "public launch" means broader outreach to accredited investor channels — not mass consumer marketing. You CAN generally solicit, but all investors must be verified accredited.

1. Create a Media Kit

WeFunder says: A media kit helps your community help YOU. Your supporters want to spread the word — **but they might not actually know how**. Prepare all copy-and-paste copy, downloadable assets, handles to tag, links, and specific asks ahead of time. In simplest form, this can be a 1-pager on Google Docs.

Email to send to supporters asking for help:

Subject: Help spread the word about iNBIO's investment round!

Hey [Name],

As you know, iNBIO is launching our private investment round on [date]. Our goal is to raise \$[goal]. To do that, we're hoping to make a big splash on launch day and hit \$[day 1 goal] on day 1. This will be a huge help building momentum.

I know you're busy, but if you have time on [launch date] within the 4-hour window of [start time] to [end time], I would appreciate any help spreading the word.

Here are a few ways you can help:

- 1. Like, Comment on, or Share our launch posts on LinkedIn and X — links in the attached doc will go live at [start time]*
- 2. Create a native post on LinkedIn using the copy and assets in the doc*

Thank you so much for your help! — Raj

iNBIO Media Kit — Google Doc Template

Create a Google Doc with this structure and share it with your supporters:

How to share iNBIO's Investment Round Launch

tl;dr: Toolkit of copy and assets to share our investment round announcement

Campaign Link: [insert WeFunder link]

Announcement Links

Instructions: During [time window] on [date], would appreciate any amplification on these posts:

1. [Raj's LinkedIn post link]: Like, comment, share
 2. [X/Twitter post link]: Like, retweet, comment
 - 3.
-

Copy Snippets

Copy and paste these if you need to describe what iNBIO is:

The short version: iNBIO builds modular systems that convert wood waste into clean fuel, carbon-storing charcoal, and renewable gas.

The long version: International BioRefineries (iNBIO) designs, builds, and operates modular fast pyrolysis systems that convert agricultural and forestry waste into bio-oil, biochar, and syngas. Based in Salisbury, MD, iNBIO serves agriculture, stormwater, construction, and carbon credit markets with engineered biochar products.

CTA: iNBIO just opened their investment round and is looking to raise \$[goal]. The biochar market is approaching \$1B and 62% of supply is locked up. Learn more and invest: [WeFunder link]

Assets

Instructions: Download any of these from this folder to post natively: [Google Drive / Dropbox link]

Video:

- 9x16 (Stories/Reels): [link]
- 1x1 (Square — LinkedIn/Instagram): [link]
- 16x9 (Landscape — YouTube/LinkedIn): [link]

Images: Choose from below:

- Raj with biochar/equipment: [link]
 - Three products shot: [link]
 - Modular container system: [link]
 - Key stats graphic: [link]
-

Tag these people in your post:

- @[Raj's LinkedIn handle]
- @[iNBIO company page]
- @[any advisors or partners with public profiles]

Hashtags: #biochar #cleanenergy #pyrolysis #carboncredits #climatetech #biomass #sustainability #investing #wefunder

Asset checklist:

- ☐ Company logo (PNG, SVG, white + dark backgrounds)
- ☐ 3-5 product photos (biochar, bio-oil, reactor, container modules)
- ☐ Raj headshot
- ☐ Pitch video in 3 formats (9x16, 1x1, 16x9)
- ☐ Key stats graphic
- ☐ Google Doc media kit created and shareable

Once people start helping, set aside time to engage and say thank you. If others are spreading the word, make sure to thank them and keep the conversation going.

2. Make a Huge Splash on Launch Day

WeFunder says: Your Public Launch is your official launch into the world — to WeFunder's audience, Google's search indexing, and anyone who stumbles upon your page. This is different from Soft Launch, which was your inner circle only.

Step 1: Draft your public announcement email

Subject: iNBIO's investment round is now open to the public

Exciting news: our private round is now open!

As you may know, we opened our investment round [X weeks ago] to let early supporters invest in iNBIO and our mission to convert biomass waste into clean energy products.

Today we're opening the round more broadly to accredited investors.

In the past [X months], iNBIO has:

- *[Impressive metric — e.g., "Processed X tons of feedstock"]*
- *[Big accomplishment — e.g., "Certified biochar to IBI/EBC standards"]*
- *[Another milestone — e.g., "Raised \$X from Y early investors"]*

We're raising capital to deploy our next production systems and begin generating recurring revenue from biochar sales, bio-oil contracts, and carbon credits.

Interested in investing? See the full details: [WeFunder link]

Or help us spread the word by forwarding this email, sharing [this post], or giving us likes and comments on LinkedIn and X.

Thank you for supporting us.

— Raj Kathuria, Founder & CEO

Step 2: Tailor and publish across ALL channels

Draft a version for every platform. **Put links in the first comment on LinkedIn and Facebook** (not in the post itself) — this gets better algorithmic reach. If you BCC an email list, **exclude investors you already contacted personally.**

Post wherever iNBIO has a digital audience:

- ☐ Company email list (Resend)
- ☐ Company LinkedIn page
- ☐ Company X/Twitter
- ☐ Company website — add announcement bar or banner (see extras below)

- ☐ Company blog

Post wherever Raj personally has an audience:

- ☐ Personal LinkedIn (this is the big one)
- ☐ Personal X/Twitter
- ☐ Personal Facebook
- ☐ Any other personal social

Pre-written LinkedIn post for Raj (personal account):

I've spent years building fast pyrolysis technology that converts biomass waste into bio-oil, biochar, and syngas. Today I'm opening iNBIO's investment round to scale what we've built.

A few things that convinced me the timing is right:

- *The biochar market is approaching \$1B and 62% of supply is locked up*
- *Carbon credits for biochar average \$164/ton — up 25% in 2 years*
- *Holcim just poured net-zero concrete with biochar at Canary Wharf*
- *ICVCM approved 3 biochar credit methodologies this year*

We're not pitching a concept. We have equipment, certified products, and three service lines. What we need is capital to build and deploy the next systems.

If you're an accredited investor interested in clean energy infrastructure — link in comments.

Happy to answer any questions below.

[Put the WeFunder link in the first comment, not the post body]

Step 3: Publish everything in one go, then engage

To save time, **batch-publish everything at once** — all channels, same morning. Then schedule time to engage with email replies, comments, and shares that come in.

It's an algorithmic game — **take time to engage** (reply to comments, thank sharers) to push your posts to greater visibility.

iNBIO Launch Day Checklist:

Morning (publish everything):

- ☐ Raj posts on personal LinkedIn (link in first comment)
- ☐ Email blast to full subscriber list (Resend campaign API)
- ☐ Post on X/Twitter with key stat
- ☐ Text/WhatsApp to 20 closest contacts asking them to share
- ☐ Send media kit doc to supporters who agreed to amplify

Midday (engage):

- ☐ Reply to every comment on LinkedIn post
- ☐ Follow-up comment with a specific data point
- ☐ Share in relevant LinkedIn groups (biochar, cleantech, climate investing)
- ☐ Thank anyone who shared publicly

Evening (update):

- ☐ Post "Day 1" update on WeFunder: "Here's where we stand..."

- ☐ Thank amplifiers individually

3 extra measures for Public Launch:

1. **Add an announcement bar to inbio.net** — a banner at the top of the website announcing the round with a link to WeFunder
2. **Add a snippet and link to Raj's email signature** — "Now raising on WeFunder: [link]"
3. **Update social bios** — add the WeFunder link to iNBIO's and Raj's LinkedIn/X bios

3. Publish Weekly Updates (12-Week Content Calendar)

WeFunder says: Fundraising is hands-on — there's no point where you "set it and forget it." You're responsible for holding the flag through the entire raise. The easiest way: show up, respond to questions, thank supporters, share how your raise is going.

Why it matters: Professional investors might invest on numbers alone, but many invest on their **connection to you and your mission**. Regular content keeps them engaged.

Who reads your updates? People who visit your page but aren't ready to invest click "Watch for Updates" — they become **Followers** and automatically receive an email every time you post. These followers are **low-hanging fruit** — on the fence, waiting to track your progress before deciding.

Rules:

- **Post at least one update every week**
- Give investors **one clear takeaway** per update — don't bundle 5 topics into one
- Spread topics across weekly updates for consistency
- Post updates from your campaign page nav bar → "Updates" → "Post"

WeFunder's 12-Week Calendar (with iNBIO content):

Week 1: Why we're raising Recap your mission, what problem you're solving, and why you're raising from investors. Set the tone for the campaign.

iNBIO: "A billion tons of biomass waste, three products from one machine, and a market that's buying faster than producers can build. Here's why we're raising capital now..."

Week 2: Share an amazing customer story A customer success story — why do they value iNBIO? What changed for them?

iNBIO: A stormwater engineer's experience specifying our biochar, or a sawmill operator who turned a waste cost into revenue.

Week 3: Give people a reason to believe Go deeper on your market, competitive advantages, or answer "why now?" Teach the audience something they didn't know.

iNBIO: "ICVCM just approved 3 biochar credit methodologies. Here's what that means for the economics of every pyrolysis operation in the country..."

Week 4: Announce a company milestone Product, hire, financial quarter, press, partnership. If you don't have one, host a webinar or live Q&A and publish the recap.

iNBIO: New feedstock agreement, equipment fabrication progress, a key hire, or host a live Q&A with the Lead Investor.

Week 5: Social proof Share your favorite comments from investors in your "What People Say" section. Let investor enthusiasm speak for you.

iNBIO: Quote 2-3 investor comments about why they invested — the more specific, the better.

Week 6: Funding milestone "We've raised \$X so far! We're \$Y away from our goal." Recap why you're raising and what the funds will do.

iNBIO: "We've raised \$[X] from [Y] investors. Here's exactly what the next \$[Z] unlocks: [specific equipment/milestone]."

Week 7: Founder story Share a personal, relatable story from Raj about how iNBIO got to where it is today. The human journey, not the corporate timeline.

iNBIO: How Raj went from biotechnology to building a reactor. The first feedstock test. The moment the economics clicked.

Week 8: Press Share excerpts from press, conference presentations, industry recognition, or podcast appearances.

iNBIO: US Biochar Initiative features, tcbiomass participation, local media coverage, any industry mentions. If none yet, share a relevant industry article and add your perspective.

Week 9: Behind-the-scenes Show a day-in-the-life snapshot. Casual video, or a blog post with timestamps, photos, and multimedia. Immerse followers in your company's life.

iNBIO: Walk through the facility. Show feedstock arriving, the reactor running, biochar being packaged. Use phone video — authentic beats polished.

Week 10: Funding milestone (repeat) Another progress update. "We've raised \$X! We're \$Y away." Recap why and what for.

iNBIO: Update the numbers, highlight what's changed since Week 6, name a specific milestone the funds will hit.

Week 11: Social proof (repeat) Share more investor comments. New testimonials from customers or partners also work here.

iNBIO: Fresh investor quotes, or a customer who just placed an order and is willing to share why.

Week 12: A note from the founders Recap progress since opening the round. Your favorite feedback. Company milestones achieved during the raise. A sincere final CTA to invest.

iNBIO: "When we opened this round [X] weeks ago, we had [state]. Today we have [progress]. Here's what's next — and why we'd love to have you with us for the next chapter."

4. Run a Successful Live Founder Q&A

WeFunder says: When raising a community round, hosting a Q&A is an effective way to build relationships with current investors and connect with potential ones. A typical event is 30-60 minutes — the founder presents their pitch, followed by 10-15 minutes of audience questions. Including key guests (like your lead investor) makes it even more valuable.

Step 1: Set a date & time

- **Mid-weeks are best** — Wednesday or Thursday
- **Best times:** 10am-12pm PST (1pm-3pm ET)
- **Duration:** No longer than 45 minutes
- Set it and stick to it
- **iNBIO target:** Week 6-7 of the campaign

Step 2: Choose a platform

- **lu.ma** — highly recommended for collecting signups (auto-sends reminders)
- **Zoom** — good for smaller groups, most people know how to use it
- **Sequel** (\$650/month) — best if you want to host the presentation on inbio.net (helps with retargeting)
- Google Meet or Zoho — free alternatives for small groups

Step 3: Create an agenda

Share the agenda with attendees beforehand so they can prepare questions. Two successful formats:

Option A — Pitch + Q&A (recommended for iNBIO):

- 20-25 min: Raj pitches the business (technology, products, market, financials)

- 10-15 min: Open audience Q&A

Option B — Lead Investor Perspective:

- 15-20 min: Raj pitches the business
- 10-15 min: Lead investor gives a personal account of why they invested
- 5-10 min: Open Q&A

Prep — anticipate these questions:

- "What's your current revenue?" — Answer honestly. If pre-revenue, explain the pipeline.
- "How does the carbon credit revenue actually work?" — Walk through Puro.earth/Verra registration, credit issuance, buyer market.
- "Who are your competitors?" — Other pyrolysis companies. Be honest about differentiation: modular, EPC model, multiple engagement types.
- "When do investors see returns?" — Equity is illiquid. Possible exit paths: acquisition, IPO, dividends. Don't promise timelines.
- "What's the biggest risk?" — Feedstock supply consistency, scaling production, carbon credit market volatility. Naming risks builds trust.

Step 4: Promote the Q&A

- Post an **update on your WeFunder page** with a summary and registration link
- Email your subscriber list with the registration link
- Post on LinkedIn and X with eye-catching graphics
- Send **reminder emails** leading up to the event (lu.ma handles this automatically)

Step 5: Conduct the live Q&A

- Test your equipment and **start on time**
- Stick to the agenda and engage with attendees
- Be **personable, enthusiastic, and confident**
- Have a **facilitator** (someone other than Raj) whose sole job is to keep tabs on the chat and waiting room
- Drop **2-3 resources in the chat** during the session — links, images, polls — to keep the audience engaged

Step 6: Follow up with attendees

Send a follow-up email the next day:

Subject: Thanks for joining our live Q&A!

Hey [Name],

Thanks for joining our live Q&A yesterday. It was great to connect and share more about iNBIO.

As promised, here are some resources:

- *[Recording of the Q&A]*
- *[Our WeFunder campaign page]*
- *[Our pitch deck / one-pager]*

If you have any more questions, feel free to reply to this email. And if you're ready to invest, you can do so here: [WeFunder link]

Thanks again, Raj

5. Promote Your Raise on Social Media

WeFunder says: Spread the word about your round to every platform where you have an audience.

CRITICAL RULE: Do NOT mention the terms of your campaign (valuation, share price, minimum investment amounts, etc.) **on channels outside the WeFunder platform** — not in emails, not on social media. Terms live on WeFunder only.

3-phase posting cadence:

Phase 1 — Launch (week of public launch):

- Tease the launch **a week out, a few days out**, and **on the day of**
- Recap who you are, why you exist, and why you're opening a round
- Cadence: daily during launch week

Phase 2 — In the middle (weeks 2-10):

- Update followers on milestones, behind-the-scenes, and your journey so far
- Suggested cadence: **2-4 times a month**
- Share: investor testimonials (screenshot from "What People Say"), customer stories, product progress, industry news

Phase 3 — Closing (final 2 weeks):

- Thank your investors and emphasize your mission and goals
- Drive urgency and gratitude — not desperation
- Cadence: increase to 2-3x/week

Post types with iNBIO examples:

Launch posts:

- **Tease (1 week out):** "We've been building something at iNBIO for a long time. Next week, I'm sharing an opportunity for you to be part of it. Stay tuned."
- **Tease (2 days out):** "In 48 hours, I'm opening iNBIO's investment round. Here's why the timing matters..." [one key stat + photo]
- **Launch day:** Full announcement post (use the LinkedIn post from Phase 3 Launch Day section). Put link in first comment.

Update posts (mid-campaign):

- Behind-the-scenes reel or photos: feedstock arriving, reactor running, products being packaged
- Screenshot an investor testimonial from your WeFunder "What People Say" section
- Share a customer testimonial over product footage
- Quote industry news and add iNBIO's angle

Closing posts:

- Milestone update: "We've crossed \$[X] from [Y] investors. \$[Z] left to hit our goal."
- Gratitude post: recap the journey since launch, thank investors, share what's next
- Final CTA: "Round closes [date]. Last chance to join: [link in comments]"

Platform strategy:

LinkedIn (primary — where accredited investors and industry decision-makers are):

- Raj's personal account is the main channel
- Always include a photo or data visual
- Put external links in the **first comment** (better algorithm reach)
- End with a soft CTA: "If you're interested in what we're building — link in comments"

X/Twitter (secondary):

- Shorter format, quote industry news with iNBIO's angle
- Tag relevant accounts (@USBiochar, industry publications)
- Retweet/quote-tweet your own WeFunder updates

Instagram (if applicable):

- Stories: screenshot your WeFunder campaign progress
- Reels: behind-the-scenes facility footage, product shots

YouTube:

- Upload pitch video
 - Post facility tours or product demos
-

6. Use Paid Media

WeFunder says: Paid ads can amplify your raise, but they should **supplement — not replace — organic promotion.**

IMPORTANT: SEC regulations require specific disclaimers on paid ads for investment offerings. Consult your WeFunder fundraising advisor before running any paid ads.

How to Use Paid Ads

LinkedIn Ads (BEST for iNBIO's Reg D 506c — where accredited investors are):

- Target: accredited investors, cleantech professionals, sustainability officers, ag industry executives
- Budget: Start with \$500-1,000 over the raise, test 2-3 ad creatives
- Creative: Product photo + key stat + "Now raising" CTA
- Objective: Drive traffic to WeFunder page

Facebook/Instagram Ads:

- Target lookalike audiences based on existing customers or website visitors
- Budget: \$500-2,000 over your raise
- Note: Less relevant for Reg D 506(c) since investors must be accredited, but can build awareness

Twitter/X Ads:

- Promote your launch tweet — good for reaching startup/investor audiences

Google Ads:

- Target keywords related to investing in your industry (e.g., "invest in biochar," "cleantech investment," "carbon credit company")

How Publishers Work

Publishers are media outlets or newsletters that feature your raise to their audience:

- **Startup newsletters** — many feature community rounds for free or for a fee
- **Industry publications** — write a press release about your raise. For iNBIO: target cleantech, biochar, renewable energy publications
- **Podcast appearances** — pitch Raj as a guest to discuss biomass-to-energy, biochar markets, or the carbon credit opportunity

The best PR is often organic: **a genuine story about why you're letting your community invest.**

How Content Partners Work

Content Partners are creators and influencers who produce content about your raise in exchange for compensation or equity:

- Video reviews or features
- Blog posts or newsletter features
- Social media posts to their audience

Choose someone whose audience aligns with your target investor demographic. For iNBIO: cleantech influencers, sustainability creators, climate-tech newsletter authors. Authenticity matters — their audience should trust their recommendations.

Campaign Managers and Strategists

Some founders hire specialists to help with their raise:

- **Crowdfunding marketing agencies** — handle your entire marketing campaign
- **Content creators** — create videos, graphics, and copy for your campaign
- **Fundraising consultants** — advise on strategy and help with outreach

WeFunder can recommend vetted partners. Ask your fundraising advisor for introductions. iNBIO also has MKT Chemistry as an existing distribution/marketing partner — coordinate with them on paid media strategy.

PHASE FOUR: Closing

The last 2 weeks before the fundraiser ends. Reach back out to everyone you've contacted, ask people to invest again or increase commitments, and drive FOMO to get a final bump. Reach 100% of your goal.

How to Close Strong

WeFunder says: Reach back out to everyone asking them to invest or increase their investment, update every day, and emphasize the closing date!

When does Closing start?

When you've reached at least **65% of your goal**, plan a date and time **1-2 weeks out** to end your round. Work with your WeFunder Account Manager to put a **countdown clock** on your campaign page while you prepare for the final bump.

Post an update EVERY DAY

Campaigns see their biggest spikes at the very beginning (launch day) and at the end. Take advantage by **posting every day to your channels and following up with every 1:1 contact that ever expressed interest.**

In every communication, celebrate the success of your campaign. Use this template across your campaign Updates:

Subject: {X days} left to invest in iNBIO's round!

Our round closes in {X days} on {date}! Invest before we close: [WeFunder link]

*If you invested in this round, from the bottom of our hearts, **thank you.** Your contribution will be fundamental for iNBIO's continual growth and success as we work to convert biomass waste into clean energy at scale.*

Each day, add a blurb on ONE of the following to mix it up:

1. Key accomplishments in the past month or quarter
2. Key plans in the next month or quarter
3. Notable investors in your round
4. Market trends in your favor (biochar market growth, carbon credit pricing, ICVCM approvals)
5. A sincere note of gratitude
6. A recap of your mission
7. A final call to invest

Text every investor who ever expressed interest

Make time to follow up with **everyone you reached out to 1:1** during your round — not just your top 10. Send a text to any larger investors that expressed interest but haven't invested yet. Make sure they know the campaign is wrapping up. Make time to chat with them.

Ramp up your promotions

If you've already set up paid ads, **activate and ramp up what's working** in this last 1-2 weeks. Increase budget on your best-performing ad creative.

Go all out (again) on the last day

On the final day, **cycle back through ALL channels** with one last reminder that this is it:

- ☐ Final WeFunder update: "Closing tonight. Here's where we stand..."
- ☐ Email blast: last chance (use the lastChanceEmail template in Resend)
- ☐ LinkedIn post with final stats: "[X] investors, [Y]% of goal, closing tonight"
- ☐ X/Twitter post
- ☐ Personal texts to anyone on the fence
- ☐ Ask supporters to share one more time

iNBIO Closing Checklist:

2 weeks out (hitting 65%+):

- ☐ Set closing date and time with WeFunder Account Manager
- ☐ Request countdown clock on campaign page
- ☐ Email reserved-but-not-completed investors: "Your reservation expires — here's how to finalize"
- ☐ Start posting daily updates on WeFunder (rotate through the 7 blurbs above)

1 week out:

- ☐ "1 week left" email to full list (Resend lastChanceEmail template)
- ☐ LinkedIn post: "One week left. Here's what we've accomplished..."
- ☐ Text/call every 1:1 contact who expressed interest but hasn't invested
- ☐ Ramp up paid ads

Final 48 hours:

- ☐ "Closing tomorrow" email
- ☐ LinkedIn post: "[X] investors, [Y]% of goal, closing tomorrow"
- ☐ Personal outreach to anyone on the fence

Final day:

- ☐ Go all out — cycle through every channel one last time (see above)

After close:

- ☐ Thank you email to all investors
 - ☐ WeFunder update: final results + what happens next
 - ☐ LinkedIn post: gratitude + next milestones
 - ☐ Begin executing on the Game Plan milestones
-

TEMPLATES

1. Validating Your Community Round

WeFunder template — "Ask for feedback while priming the pump":

Subject: Would you join our community of investors? Pre-header: We're considering a private round!

Hi [Name],

iNBIO is at an exciting stage. We're considering opening a private investment round on WeFunder — giving our supporters and industry contacts the chance to invest in our growth.

Before we commit, I'd love your honest feedback:

- 1. Would you personally be interested in investing?*
- 2. If so, roughly how much would you consider? (\$5,000-\$50,000+)*
- 3. Do you know others who might be interested?*

Your input will directly shape whether and how we move forward with this. Thanks for being part of our journey.

Raj Kathuria iNBIO

Track responses. If 30%+ say yes, you have enough signal to proceed.

iNBIO validation targets: Existing /invest email subscribers, LinkedIn connections who've engaged with Raj's posts, industry contacts, cleantech angels.

2. Asking for Feedback on Your Pitch

WeFunder template:

Subject: Feedback on our pitch?

Hey [Name],

[Some personalization]

Exciting news — I'm going to be launching a private investment round on WeFunder. Before I go live, I'd love your sharp eyes on our pitch.

Here's a preview link: [WeFunder page link](#)

Would love your thoughts on:

- Is the story clear and compelling?*
- Anything confusing or missing?*
- Would you invest? (No pressure!)*

Your feedback would mean a lot. And if you do want to invest, you'll get first access before we go public.

Thanks! Raj

Send to **5-10 trusted people** who will give honest feedback. Incorporate before soft launch.

3. Marketing Your Fundraise in TTW — 8 Emails

TTW = Testing the Waters. For Reg D 506(c), the exact TTW disclosure language may differ from Reg CF — consult your WeFunder advisor. The email cadence and strategy still apply.

Already built: Your Resend email infrastructure + drip templates are in place at `site/src/lib/email-templates.ts`.

REQUIRED: TTW Disclosure

EVERY TTW email must include this disclosure at the bottom (adapt for Reg D 506(c)):

International BioRefineries, LLC is "testing the waters" to gauge investor interest in an offering. No money or other consideration is being solicited. If sent, it will not be accepted. No offer to buy securities will be accepted. Any indication of interest involves no obligation or commitment of any kind.

Email #1: Pre-marketing

Subject: Become an investor in iNBIO

We're about to launch a private investment round for iNBIO on WeFunder — giving our supporters and community the chance to invest in our growth.

This means we're letting our biggest supporters become early investors in iNBIO. At this stage, we are "testing the waters" to gauge investor interest. No money or other consideration is being solicited.

We're launching on [DATE]. Will you join us?

Keep an eye out tomorrow for details on how to get involved!

[TTW Disclosure]

Email #2: Initial CTA with VIP offer

Subject: iNBIO's Private Round is Live!

*Our private round is now live! You're invited to join our **exclusive early round** during our testing the waters phase. We're giving our biggest supporters an opportunity to get in first.*

In the past year, iNBIO has:

- *Designed and tested our proprietary fast pyrolysis reactor*
- *Certified biochar to IBI/EBC international standards*
- *Launched 3 service lines: product sales, Build + Operate, OEM equipment*

This round of funding will allow us to:

- *Deploy our next production system*
- *Lock feedstock supply agreements*
- *Begin generating recurring revenue from biochar, bio-oil, and carbon credits*

Check out our WeFunder page and make a reservation: [URL]

[TTW Disclosure]

Email #3: Live Call Invite

Subject: Sign up for our iNBIO investor seminar!

We're excited about the momentum we've been seeing — \$[X] in reservations so far! We wanted to make sure you didn't miss out.

We're hosting a live call for all prospective supporters who may have questions about our round, what the opportunity is, and how it works.

Join us on [DATE] at [URL] for our presentation and a live Q&A session.

[TTW Disclosure]

Email #4: Call Recording

Subject: *Only \$[X] left in our early round!*

We've been blown away by the support since we launched. We've received \$[XX,XXX] in reservations!

*Whether you join us in this round or not, **thank you**. We're grateful for all your support.*

Space is running out to make a reservation, so don't wait! For this limited time, we're offering investors [INSERT TERMS].

Make a reservation here: [URL]

[TTW Disclosure]

Email #5: Closing VIP Terms

Subject: *Only \$[X] left before our early offer expires!*

Our round is still going strong! We're so grateful to have already received \$[XX,XXX] in reservations.

Have you gotten involved yet? Over [X] people have already made reservations, and there's only \$[X] left before our early offer fills up. Once this allotment is filled, there won't be another chance to get this deal!

[Positive Investor Comment Screenshot]

[TTW Disclosure]

Email #6: Progress Update

Subject: *Only \$[X] left before our round sells out!*

What a thrilling couple of [weeks/months] it has been. We are so grateful for the outpouring of support that has allowed us to get so close to our goal.

Here is what we've been up to since we launched:

- *[Update #1]*
- *[Update #2]*
- *[Update #3]*

At this stage, many of our reservation holders are increasing their allocations. [Customer Testimonial]

If you want to invest or increase your reservation, take action now — our round is closing soon! [URL]

P.S. [Attach a quick video of Raj thanking everyone for the investments]

[TTW Disclosure]

Email #7: 48 Hours Left

Subject: *48 hours left to invest!*

Help us close out our round with a bang!

In the last [X time], we've received \$[XXX,XXX] in reservations from our day-one supporters, customers, community, and friends. This funding will help us build the next chapter of iNBIO — giving us the capital to deploy our next production systems and scale biochar and bio-oil revenue.

If you've already made a reservation, **thank you**. If you haven't, what are you waiting for? There's still room in this round.

[Invest Now button/link]

P.S. [Attach a quick video of Raj thanking everyone]

[TTW Disclosure]

Email #8: 12 Hours Left

Subject: 12 hours before closing! Closing at [TIME] **Pre-header:** This time we mean it... LAST CHANCE TO INVEST IN iNBIO!

Well, here we are, at the end. It's been such an incredible journey so far, and watching our community show up to support us has been endlessly fulfilling. If you made a reservation in this round, from the bottom of our hearts, **thank you**. Your contribution will be fundamental for iNBIO's continual growth as we work to convert biomass waste into clean energy at scale.

If you haven't made a reservation yet, we probably don't have to remind you that this is your last chance... but we're going to anyways. This is your last chance!

Still not convinced? Check out what we've been up to:

- [Company Update #1]
- [Company Update #2]
- [Company Update #3]

We're almost at the finish line, and we hope you'll be there with us when we cross it!

[Invest Now button/link]

P.S. [Attach a quick video of Raj thanking everyone]

[TTW Disclosure]

4. Marketing Your Fundraise Post-Launch — 9 Emails

Post-launch email series from Soft Launch to Closing. For Reg D 506(c), these apply once the private round is live and accepting real investments.

IMPORTANT DISCLAIMER — What you CANNOT say outside WeFunder

Do NOT mention the terms of your campaign on channels outside of the WeFunder platform (emails, social media, etc.). Terms include:

1. **Amount of securities offered**
2. **Nature of securities offered** (e.g., valuation cap)
3. **Price of securities**
4. **Closing date of offering period**
5. **Planned use of proceeds**
6. **Progress toward meeting the funding target**

Keep terms on WeFunder only. In emails and social, you can share excitement, milestones, and mission — but not deal specifics.

Email #1: Pre-marketing

Subject: *Become an owner in iNBIO!*

We've just launched our investment round — what does that mean?

This means we're letting our customers and biggest supporters become investors in iNBIO. We decided to host our round on WeFunder to share the upside of our success with the people who know us best: our family, friends, and customers. You are our foundation.

Our round is about building a network of people who share our mission and values. Whether or not you're an accredited investor — we want to become the best possible company for all of you.

Keep an eye out for more details on how to get involved!

Raj

Email #2: Pre-marketing (Why invest?)

Subject: *Why you should consider investing in iNBIO*

Hello,

We re-introduced you to the concept of our investment round, and invited you to learn more. Today let's get into it a bit more.

Why should you invest? *Investing is not just something for Wall Street. Through platforms like WeFunder, you can invest in companies you believe in. And honestly, you should know something: why we started iNBIO, what the business model is, why we think this is the right time.*

What if I'm an international investor? *WeFunder accepts investors from most countries.*

We're going to be in touch with more as the round gets off the ground!

Raj

Email #3: Initial CTA with VIP offer

Subject: *iNBIO's round is live! You're invited.*

In the past year, iNBIO has achieved a lot:

- *[Milestone #1]*
- *[Milestone #2]*
- *[Milestone #3]*

...and we're so excited to do even more! We're really excited about the growth iNBIO has seen over the last few months. And we have even more exciting plans for continuing to ramp up our growth in the coming year, with your help!

Here is a picture of us in action: [TEAM PICTURE]

Raj

Email #4: Live Call Invite

Subject: *Sign up for our WeFunder investor seminar!*

As you know, we recently launched our round on WeFunder! We're really excited about the momentum we've been seeing, and wanted to make sure that you didn't miss out on this unique opportunity!

We understand that most people are not familiar with how private investment rounds work, and that's why we've decided to host a live call for all prospective investors who may have more questions about our round, what the opportunity is, and how it works.

Please join us on [DATE] at [URL] for the presentation of our campaign and a live Q&A. We look forward to seeing you and answering any questions you may have!

If you haven't seen our WeFunder page yet, check it out here: [URL]

Raj

Email #5: Call Recording (Consideration)

Subject: *There's still time to invest in iNBIO's round.*

We're blown away by your support since we launched our round on WeFunder [a week ago].

*Whether you join us in this round or not, **thank you**. We're so grateful for all your support over the years and appreciate any help you can give, whether it be in writing a check or sharing our page with your friends.*

Space is running out to invest under our current terms, so don't wait and lose your chance at getting the most bang for your buck!

Invest here: [URL]

Raj

Email #6: Closing VIP Terms

Subject: *Get in on our terms while you still can!*

Our WeFunder round is still going strong! We're so grateful to have already raised funds so quickly in such a short amount of time.

Have you gotten involved yet? Once our current slots fill up, there won't be another chance to get this deal! We hope that you will join us in this round and help us achieve our goal!

[Positive Investor Comment Screenshot]

Raj

P.S. Here's a quick video recording on how to open an account and make the investment: [URL]

Email #7: Progress Update

Subject: *Invest in iNBIO's round!*

What a thrilling couple of [weeks/months] it has been. We are so grateful for the outpouring of support from people like you that has allowed us to get so close to our goal.

If you haven't invested yet and want to see some more info, here is what we have been up to since we launched: (please refrain from mentioning the terms of your campaign when updating investors)

- *[Update #1]*
- *[Update #2]*
- *[Update #3]*

At this stage, many of our investors are increasing their allocations. [Customer Testimonial]

If you want to invest or increase your investment, take action now — our round is closing soon! [URL]

Raj

P.S. [Attach a quick video of Raj thanking everyone for the investments]

Email #8: Time is running out

Subject: Time is running out to invest in iNBIO!

Help us close out our round with a bang!

For the past [X days/months], we've been raising from our day-one supporters, fans, customers, community, and friends. This funding will help us build the next chapter of iNBIO — giving us the proper working capital to deploy our next production systems, lock feedstock agreements, and begin generating recurring revenue.

If you've already invested in our campaign, thank you. We are so grateful for your support and contribution, no matter the check size. If you haven't invested yet, what are you waiting for? There's still room in this round to get involved.

[Invest Now button/link]

Raj

P.S. [Attach a quick video of Raj thanking everyone]

Email #9: Closing soon

Subject: What a ride it has been. **Pre-header:** Time is running out to invest in iNBIO!

Well, here we are, at the end. It's been such an incredible journey so far, and watching our community show up to support us has been endlessly fulfilling. If you invested in this round, from the bottom of our hearts, **thank you**. Your contribution will be fundamental for iNBIO's continual growth and success as we work to convert biomass waste into clean energy at scale.

Still not convinced? Check out what we've been up to during the course of this raise:

- [Company Update #1]
- [Company Update #2]
- [Company Update #3]

We hope you'll be there with us at the finish line when we cross it!

[Invest Now button/link]

Raj

P.S. [Attach a quick video of Raj thanking everyone]

ACTION ITEMS FOR RAJ

Before anything else:

- ☐ Set up private round page at <https://wefunder.com/private-round>
- ☐ Watch the Loom walkthrough Read sent: <https://www.loom.com/share/b0333bf60b4c4818bf3fa271674249ec>
- ☐ Confirm lead investor (Ajay Tandon?)
- ☐ Align on valuation and raise target

Phase 1 deliverables to produce:

- ☐ Film 60-90 second video (use script above)
- ☐ Gather product photos: biochar, bio-oil, reactor, container modules

- ☐ Professional headshot
- ☐ Fill in pitch slides on WeFunder (copy from above)
- ☐ Fill in actual equipment pricing (marked \$X in Business Model)
- ☐ Add any revenue numbers, LOIs, or contracts to Traction slide

Phase 2 deliverables:

- ☐ Build outreach list of 50+ contacts (use tiers above)
- ☐ Personalize outreach messages
- ☐ Prepare mailing list email (use Resend infrastructure)

Phase 3 deliverables:

- ☐ Assemble media kit folder
- ☐ Draft launch day LinkedIn post (template above)
- ☐ Set up 12-week content calendar in a spreadsheet
- ☐ Schedule Q&A session (week 6-7)

Phase 4:

- ☐ Prepare closing email sequence
- ☐ Plan final push outreach